

LESSON 8: Various Cataloguing Methods

8.1 Original cataloguing

Original cataloguing can be defined as a process whereby cataloguers prepare bibliographic records of information resources from scratch. It is done without the use of a pre-existing catalogue record for that information resource. Original cataloguing is also defined as creating a catalogue record for an item without the aid of an existing library record.

- It requires good training and apprenticeship; proficiency both in descriptive cataloguing and in subject cataloguing, and familiarity with the cataloguing tools.
- Original cataloguing is presumed to be tasking and requires intelligent and articulate persons with adequate skills, knowledge and experience.

8.2 Copy cataloguing

Copy cataloguing is defined as the adaptation of a pre-existing bibliographic record to fit the characteristics of the item being processed, “with modifications to correct obvious errors and minor adjustments to reflect locally accepted cataloguing practice” Copy cataloguing is mostly required for books that are difficult to catalogue and completely new books. However, for books that are already in existence in the library, application of ICT makes copy cataloguing easy as with Internet access and a click of a button/ mouse, information on the book or related books comes up and the cataloguer takes the required decision. Copy cataloguing can also be manually done with the aid of national bibliography and could be electronically carried out if the national bibliography is hosted online.

8.3 Online cataloguing

- **Online cataloguing** can be defined as the process of using bibliographic information stored in bibliographic utilities or online catalogues. It is a derivative of copy cataloguing. Online cataloguing and classification on the web have improved cataloguers work output as library resources are processed faster using appropriate software. Cataloguers who catalogue online do some modifications peculiar to their own library needs.

However, since there are many national publications that are not online, original cataloguing still becomes indispensable.

- Another form of online cataloguing is the use of other libraries Online Public Access Catalogue (OPAC) in cataloguing and classification practices. OPAC can be defined as a computerized library catalogue.
- Most libraries have made their OPAC accessible from a server to users and other libraries globally.

8.4 Human Input in Online Cataloguing

- Despite great advances in computer technology, computers still depend on human input. Computers can think faster, but they can't think with as much complexity as humans.
- Information and Communication Technology (ICT) has demonstrated its impact on library systems, services, operations, and particularly bibliographic control. ICT ensures easy integration of various library activities, increases efficiency in acquisition, cataloguing, classification, access to data, and information retrieval and dissemination.
- Online cataloguing saves the time of the staff and users. Application of ICT to cataloguing and classification enables effective bibliographic control, as information explosion experienced in the digital age has brought about creation of various kinds of publications such that users are faced with problems of how to identify and locate recorded knowledge as contained in books (printed and electronic), serials, databases, and other media that currently flood the book industry and the web.

Cataloguing involves two parts, which are **descriptive cataloguing and subject cataloguing thus;**

- Descriptive cataloguing entails providing bibliographic description using the elements available in the information resource to be described and being guided by choice of access points. The elements used in bibliographic description include the author, title, edition, place of publication, name of the publisher and date of publication, International Standard Book Number (ISBN) for books, or International Standard Serial Numbers (ISSN) for serials, among

others.

- Through cataloguing, individual items are made to be unique from other items. In order to maintain international standards, descriptive cataloguing is carried out with the aid of Anglo-American Cataloguing Rules, second edition (AACR2), which is gradually being replaced by Resource Description and Access (RDA) in this digital age. Some libraries, mostly in developed countries have started using the Resource Description and Access (RDA) in place of AACR2 in cataloguing. Many national libraries like British Library, Library of Congress, National Library of Australia, National Library of Singapore, National Library of Malaysia and National Library of Philippines have implemented the RDA in their cataloguing practices.

8.5 Database Creation and Maintenance

The Bibliographic Database for Library Automation has to be created in such a way that it will last a life time regardless of the system software changes. It is important to note that System software and vendors come and go, hardware becomes obsolete, but a bibliographic database can survive for decades. A high quality, well maintained bibliographic file can be transferred from one generation of a system to another or migrated between successive systems from different vendors.

In addition to being the most lasting system component, if not properly constructed, the bibliographic database can also be the most limiting element of a multifunction integrated automated library system.

The bibliographic file creation and maintenance practices that will affect a library's ability to use various automated system capabilities, for both current and future applications.

Database Creation Options

There are a number of ways of creating the bibliographic database to be mounted on a local automated library system. **Most approaches rely on a resource file of machine-readable records to provide cataloging copy, in preference to creating and keying all records from scratch.**

Cataloging resource files come in a variety of forms: a library database mounted on a local automated system, a CD-ROM stand-alone cataloging support system, or a remote file accessed via telecommunication linkages (such as OCLC - Online Computer Library Center which is a nonprofit membership organization that promotes cooperation among libraries worldwide. More than 54,000 libraries in 109 countries use OCLC services to locate, acquire, catalogue, lend and preserve print and electronic library materials).

The resource file is searched for a record that describes the item being cataloged. If an exact match is not found but the file contains a record for a similar item, a derived catalog record is created by selecting and editing the near-matching record to represent the item in hand.

If no copy record can be identified, an original record is prepared. It is important to know that all copy cataloging requires some editing so as to add local library-specific data such as call number or local subject headings. Record creation and record editing can be performed either on the system that supports the resource file or on the local automated library system.

The Importance of Adherence to MARC

- What may appear to be a reasonable time and labor saving variation from standard **MARC (the acronym for MACHine-Readable Cataloging)** may be **a deterrent when sharing data.** MARC defines a data format that emerged from a **Library of Congress-led** initiative that began nearly forty years ago.
- Other important data elements are standard numbers such as the Library of Congress Card Number (LCCN) and the International Standard Book Number (ISBN).
- Although often regarded as of little importance in local system databases, the above numbers assume significance in external applications, such as;

- ✓ When a library is seeking to produce a microfiche or CD-ROM catalog;
- ✓ To migrate the database from one automated library system to another
- ✓ To merge its records with those from other libraries on a shared automated system; or to report holdings to a union catalog.

Appropriate Fields: Consistent Formats

- It is not enough to record data in the appropriate field. It must also be recorded in a consistent format.
- Some automated library systems and cataloging support systems enforce formatting consistency by providing input validation routines that either alert the operator to an incorrectly formatted number and prevent it from being added to the database, or automatically reformat the data once it has been keyed. However, most multifunction integrated automated library systems neither check nor manipulate input data; they accept whatever is keyed and output it unchanged.
- Appropriate and consistent formatting conventions must be followed if standard numbers are to be readily available for machine manipulation.
- Capabilities to support the output of MARC records emphasizes the need for libraries to expand their data entry horizons beyond the confines of any local system usage.

Correcting a Defective Database

- It is expensive to develop and maintain a bibliographic database, and the cost can escalate dramatically if ill-considered shortcuts result in records that cannot support the full range of automated library system applications, necessitating major revision or upgrade of the file.

N.B.:

A library can correct defective records by calling them up and changing them one at a time or, if the problems are widespread and consistent, it can contract with a

bibliographic tape processing service to prepare custom software to correct the records automatically. Some automated library system vendors also provide these services. The more customization a vendor is required to perform to prepare a file for loading or transfer, however, the more the library can expect to pay for the service. It is therefore advisable to strictly adhere to the set international standards to avoid future inconsistencies and subsequent correction expenses.

8.6 How to Search in an Online Catalogue

- In order to get electronic databases to divulge their secrets, you have to know how to speak to them. Think of it as digital baby talk.
- You have to tell a computer if you want all the words of your search to appear in the results. You might also need to let the computer know which terms you don't want to appear in your results. One needs to devise a way of how to speak (search) to a database to get the best results for meeting ones or client's information needs.
- **The Various Search Types are indicated below;**

Basic search types	Search operators
Keyword Natural language Subject Heading Browsing thesaurus or index	Boolean Proximity operators Plurals Truncation Wildcards